



7 Opera Opera seems to be doing something right if it repeatedly outperforms other browsers in most tests including the one we conducted recently on thinkdigit.com. With many of the features of other browsers being built in, it offers a stable browsing environment. Definitely a browser of choice for most of the Team Digit members



8 VLC Despite media players such as KMPlayer and Media Player Classic, VLC still remains the last line of defence against a stubbornly unplayable video file. If not very factual, this still remains the perception amongst most users. Most people still have VLC on their systems, even if not as the default player, it's still there, which is why the high rating on this listing.



6 Firefox Firefox is again one of the most successful opensource projects of all time – built by geeks and for geeks. The browser was at one time the most customisable, secure and fast browser. Hence the loyal fan following even today. It's slowly losing ground to other browsers such as Google Chrome and Opera.



5 Winamp Winamp is primarily well known as a music player than a full fledged media player. The look and feel, minute features like auto-tagging with accuracy, pluggins, visualisation, sorting, shortcuts, and tons of other things make this a favourite of a lot of people. Flaws? Sure, it's heavy on ram usage, but there are workarounds.

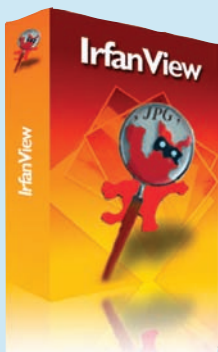


4 uTorrent Just 314.8 kB ? "OMG" is how most users react when they first encounter uTorrent. This small client is easy on resources, has a great looking interface and awesome features. Feature set even includes a Web UI

2 Google Chrome Google's philosophy - that the browser is going to be our gateway to personal computing in the future - seems to be directly reflected in this ranking. After a productivity suite the first category of software to get featured was a browser and what a co-incidence that it's Google Chrome. Chrome has come a long way from the buggy, crash happy little infuriating !#%^& it used to be. Now with extension support, the newly launched app store (which we're still skeptical is just a jazzed up speed dial) and more stable releases, it seems to be the favourite browser overall.



3 Irfan View Irfan View has been and maybe will remain the primary tool for all of us when it comes to batch processing, editing, and resizing images.



How we rated

The ranking here might seem outright unfair to some (read:fanboys) but even excluding that annoying group many of you must be drawing deep breaths to launch off on a tirade right? What happened to great software like Portable Apps, Handbrake, Miranda, Bumptop and so many more?; you might ask. Let us first explain how we arrived at this list. Each Digit team member was asked to rank from 1 to n, an exhaustive list of software that contained close to a hundred of the best software, spanning categories such as system tools, communication, multimedia, UI enhancement, productivity etc. Here reviewers were asked to give a composite rating after taking into account factors such as usefulness, usage, cool factor, and general affinity. Once the ratings were done a weighted average was taken to come to a result. As it turns out, although everyone in the team who voted agreed that they software that failed to make the top 50 are indeed great programs, but when comparing them to other day-to-day sort of applications, they just dropped down the pecking order. Even in such a geeky team there were some who hadn't had the occasion to try gems like "Everything", "TheSage", "EasyBCD" and many more. So stay tuned for our "top Windows software you've never heard of but must have" list sometime soon. And keep the hate mail coming.



MS Office Suite 2010

Let's face it, this one thing where Microsoft really knows what it's doing. Whether it's the simplicity of Word or the complex pivot tables, look-ups, and macros you can run in Excel or even the the impressive fluidity of PowerPoint, we all seem to love this productivity tool. Also, it's not really a surprise that a productivity suite is at the top of this countdown right? After all you use a PC most often for productivity. The office suite figured amongst the top three for each of the Digit team members without exception.

